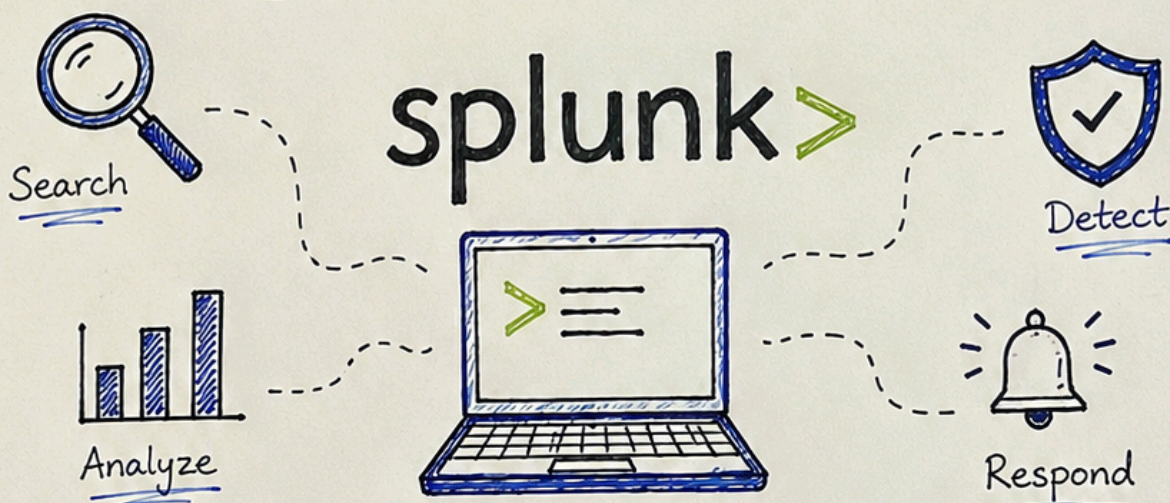




# TOP 12 SPL QUERIES

## Every SOC Analyst Should Know

Practical Splunk Queries for  
Daily SOC Monitoring & Investigations



★ What you will learn in this notebook:

- ☒ Most used SPL queries in Daily SOC Shift
- ☒ Real-world examples
- ☒ Easy explanations for beginners
- ☒ Useful for monitoring, investigations & threat hunting



Better Queries → Better Visibility → Better Security

Prepared by  
Blueteamers



Instagram:  
@blueteamers\_

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**FREE  
NOTES**



index = \*

index = \* "failed password"

**FREE**  
**NOTES**

## QUERY 02: Failed Logins (Windows)



### SPL QUERY:

```
index = windows EventCode = 4625
```

### EXAMPLE:

Find all Windows failed authentication attempts.

### • WHAT IT DOES:

Searches Windows failed logon events.

### • WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Detect brute-force attacks
- Identify password spraying
- Investigate suspicious authentication attempts

### QUERY BREAKDOWN:

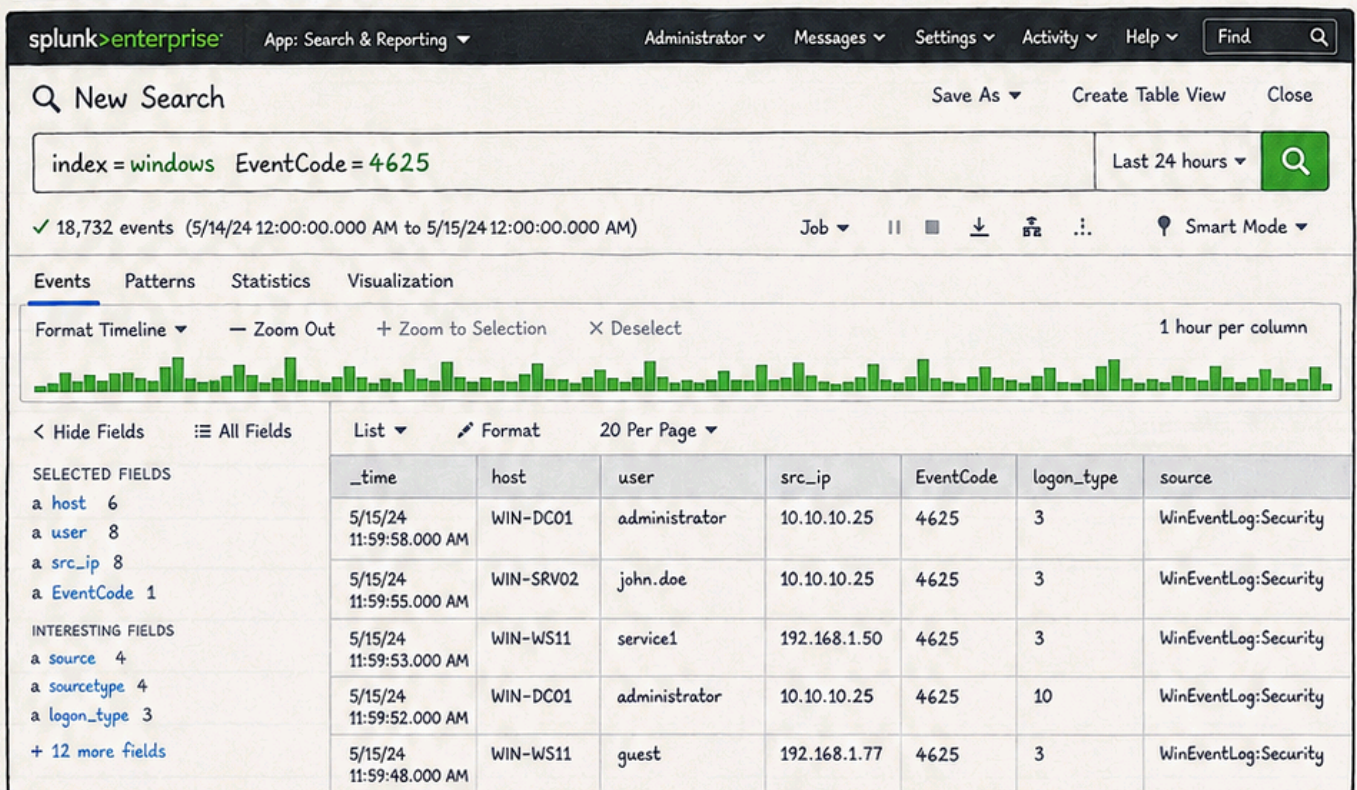
- `index = windows` → Search Windows logs
- `EventCode = 4625` → Failed logon event (Windows Security Event ID)



### BEGINNER TIP:

Always combine this query with `src_ip`, `user`, and `time` to understand the full picture of the failed attempts.

### REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:



The screenshot shows the Splunk Enterprise interface with the search query `index = windows EventCode = 4625` entered in the search bar. The results show 18,732 events from 5/14/24 12:00:00.000 AM to 5/15/24 12:00:00.000 AM. The visualization is a bar chart showing the distribution of events over time. Below the chart, a table displays the top results.

| Selected Fields    | Time                    | Host      | User          | Src IP       | Event Code | Logon Type | Source               |
|--------------------|-------------------------|-----------|---------------|--------------|------------|------------|----------------------|
| a host 6           | 5/15/24 11:59:58.000 AM | WIN-DC01  | administrator | 10.10.10.25  | 4625       | 3          | WinEventLog:Security |
| a user 8           | 5/15/24 11:59:55.000 AM | WIN-SRV02 | john.doe      | 10.10.10.25  | 4625       | 3          | WinEventLog:Security |
| a src_ip 8         | 5/15/24 11:59:53.000 AM | WIN-WS11  | service1      | 192.168.1.50 | 4625       | 3          | WinEventLog:Security |
| a EventCode 1      | 5/15/24 11:59:52.000 AM | WIN-DC01  | administrator | 10.10.10.25  | 4625       | 10         | WinEventLog:Security |
| INTERESTING FIELDS | 5/15/24 11:59:48.000 AM | WIN-WS11  | guest         | 192.168.1.77 | 4625       | 3          | WinEventLog:Security |





## QUERY 03: Successful Logins (Windows)



### SPL QUERY:

```
index = windows EventCode = 4624
```

### EXAMPLE:

Track all successful Windows logon events.

### WHAT IT DOES:

Finds all successful Windows authentication events.

### WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Verify legitimate user access
- Investigate suspicious successful logins
- Correlate with failed attempts (possible brute force)

### QUERY BREAKDOWN:

- `index = windows` → Search Windows logs
- `EventCode = 4624` → Successful logon (Windows Security Event ID)



### BEGINNER TIP:

EventCode 4624 shows successful logins.

Always review `user`, `src_ip`, and `host` columns for context.

### REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

splunk>enterprise App: Search & Reporting Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

Q New Search Save As Create Table View Close

index = windows EventCode = 4624 Last 24 hours

✓ 67,321 events (5/14/24 12:00:00.000 AM to 5/15/24 12:00:00.000 AM) Job || Download Print ... Smart Mode

Events Patterns Statistics Visualization

Format Timeline Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect 1 hour per column

< Hide Fields All Fields List Format 20 Per Page

| SELECTED FIELDS | INTERESTING FIELDS | Table Headers |
|-----------------|--------------------|---------------|
| a host 5        | a logon_type 3     | _time         |
| a user 7        | a source 4         | host          |
| a src_ip 8      | a sourcetype 4     | user          |
| a EventCode 1   | + 10 more fields   | src_ip        |
|                 |                    | EventCode     |
|                 |                    | logon_type    |
|                 |                    | source        |

|                         |           |               |              |      |    |                      |
|-------------------------|-----------|---------------|--------------|------|----|----------------------|
| 5/15/24 11:59:58.000 AM | WIN-DC01  | administrator | 10.10.10.25  | 4624 | 2  | WinEventLog:Security |
| 5/15/24 11:59:55.000 AM | WIN-SRV02 | john.doe      | 10.10.10.25  | 4624 | 10 | WinEventLog:Security |
| 5/15/24 11:59:53.000 AM | WIN-WS11  | service1      | 192.168.1.50 | 4624 | 3  | WinEventLog:Security |
| 5/15/24 11:59:51.000 AM | WIN-DC01  | administrator | 10.10.10.26  | 4624 | 3  | WinEventLog:Security |
| 5/15/24 11:59:48.000 AM | WIN-WS11  | guest         | 192.168.1.77 | 4624 | 8  | WinEventLog:Security |

Time of Event Host (System) User (Account) Source IP Address Event ID (4624) Logon Type Log Source



### QUERY 04: Top Source IPs (Most Active)



### SPL QUERY:

```
index = windows
| stats count by src_ip
| sort - count
| head 10
```

EXAMPLE:

Find the top 10 source IP addresses generating the most events.

- WHAT IT DOES:

Identifies the source IP addresses with the highest volume of activity in your environment.

- WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Detect potential attacking or scanning IPs
- Identify unusual or noisy IP addresses
- Pivot into investigation for a specific IP

QUERY BREAKDOWN:

- `stats count by src_ip` → Count events grouped by source IP
- `sort - count` → Highest count first
- `head 10` → Show top 10 results



**BEGINNER TIP:**

If you see an unfamiliar IP at the top with a very high count, it could be a sign of suspicious or malicious activity.

### REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

The screenshot shows the Splunk search interface. At the top, the navigation bar includes 'splunk>enterprise', 'App: Search & Reporting', and various user roles and settings. The search bar contains the query: `index = windows | stats count by src_ip | sort - count | head 10`. The results are displayed in a table with 10 rows, showing the top source IPs by event count. A green arrow points to the table with a handwritten note: 'These are the Top 10 Source IPs generating the most events in the environment.'

|     | src_ip       | count |
|-----|--------------|-------|
| 1.  | 10.10.10.25  | 845   |
| 2.  | 10.10.10.15  | 612   |
| 3.  | 172.16.10.20 | 488   |
| 4.  | 192.168.1.50 | 376   |
| 5.  | 10.10.20.30  | 321   |
| 6.  | 203.0.113.45 | 287   |
| 7.  | 10.10.10.55  | 214   |
| 8.  | 172.16.10.15 | 198   |
| 9.  | 203.0.113.78 | 165   |
| 10. | 10.10.30.40  | 142   |



## QUERY 05: Investigate Activity from One IP



### SPL QUERY:

```
index=* src_ip="10.10.10.25"
| stats count by sourcetype, host
```

### EXAMPLE:

You have an alert about IP 10.10.10.25. Use this query to see all activity from that IP.

### WHAT IT DOES:

Finds all events in the environment where the specific source IP address was involved.

### WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Investigate suspicious or malicious IP addresses
- Pivot from an alert to understand impact
- Identify systems and data sources involved
- Build a timeline of activity for the IP

### QUERY BREAKDOWN:

- `index=*` → Search all indexes
- `src_ip="..."` → Filter events by the given IP address
- `stats count by sourcetype, host` → Count events grouped by log source type and host



### BEGINNER TIP:

Replace "10.10.10.25" with any IP from your alert. This helps you quickly see where the IP was active and what it did.

### REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

splunk>enterprise App: Search & Reporting Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

Q New Search Save As Create Table View Close

index=\* src\_ip="10.10.10.25" | stats count by sourcetype, host Last 24 hours

✓ 9,842 events (5/14/24 12:00:00.000 AM to 5/15/24 12:00:00.000 AM) Job || | .: Smart Mode

Events Patterns Statistics (10) Visualization

|     | sourcetype              | host         | count |
|-----|-------------------------|--------------|-------|
| 1.  | WinEventLog:Security    | WIN-DC01     | 2,341 |
| 2.  | WinEventLog:Security    | WIN-SRV02    | 1,876 |
| 3.  | WinEventLog:Security    | WIN-WS11     | 1,432 |
| 4.  | linux:syslog            | WEB-SERVER01 | 1,024 |
| 5.  | pan:traffic             | FIREWALL-01  | 845   |
| 6.  | suricata                | IDS-01       | 612   |
| 7.  | WinEventLog:System      | WIN-DC01     | 478   |
| 8.  | WinEventLog:Application | WIN-SRV02    | 395   |
| 9.  | ossec                   | WAZUH-MGR    | 268   |
| 10. | pulse_secure            | VPN-GW01     | 251   |

This shows which hosts and log sources generated the most events from IP 10.10.10.25.





## QUERY 06: Find the Most Active Users



### SPL QUERY:

```
index = windows
| stats count by user
| sort - count
| head 10
```

### EXAMPLE:

Identify the users generating the highest number of events in your environment.

### • WHAT IT DOES:

Finds users who are generating the most events.

### • WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Detect highly active or suspicious user accounts
- Identify compromised or abused accounts
- Find unusual service account activity
- Prioritize users for further investigation

### QUERY BREAKDOWN:

- index = windows → Search Windows events
- stats count by user → Count events grouped by user
- sort - count → Show highest count first
- head 10 → Show top 10 results



### BEGINNER TIP:

A high event count does not always mean malicious activity. Always analyze the user's role, host, source IP, and timeline.

### REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

The screenshot shows a Splunk search interface with the query: `index = windows | stats count by user | sort - count | head 10`. The results are displayed in a table with 10 rows, showing the top users by event count.

|     | user          | count |
|-----|---------------|-------|
| 1.  | administrator | 1,245 |
| 2.  | svc_backup    | 845   |
| 3.  | john.doe      | 423   |
| 4.  | svc_admin     | 312   |
| 5.  | helpdesk      | 287   |
| 6.  | krishna.p     | 214   |
| 7.  | svc_sql       | 178   |
| 8.  | guest         | 156   |
| 9.  | ramesh.k      | 142   |
| 10. | testuser      | 98    |

← These are the Top 10 users generating the most events in the selected time range.





## QUERY 07: Search Suspicious Commands (PowerShell / Command-Line Hunting)



### SPL QUERY:

```
index=* ("powershell" OR "cmd.exe" OR
          "whoami" OR "net user")
| stats count by host, user
| sort - count
```

### EXAMPLE:

Search for common command-line and PowerShell keywords that attackers or administrators often use. Helps in quick threat hunting.

### • WHAT IT DOES:

Finds events containing suspicious command-line or PowerShell keywords across all indexes.

### • WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Detect suspicious command execution
- Investigate PowerShell abuse
- Find potential lateral movement or recon activity
- Quick threat hunting during incidents

### QUERY BREAKDOWN:

- `index=*` → Search all indexes
- `("powershell" OR "cmd.exe" OR "whoami")` → Search for any of these keywords
- `stats count by host, user` → Group results by host and user
- `sort - count` → Highest count first



### BEGINNER TIP:

Finding these keywords doesn't always mean malicious activity. Always check the user, host context, parent process, and timeline before concluding.

### REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

splunk>enterprise App: Search & Reporting Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

New Search Save As Create Table View Close

index=\* ("powershell" OR "cmd.exe" OR "whoami" OR "net user") | stats count by host, user | sort - count Last 24 hours

✓ 15,672 events (5/14/24 12:00:00.000 AM to 5/15/24 12:00:00.000 AM) Job II □ ⬇ ⬆ ⋮ Smart Mode

| Events | Patterns     | Statistics (10) | Visualization |
|--------|--------------|-----------------|---------------|
|        | host         | user            | count         |
| 1.     | WIN-DC01     | administrator   | 24            |
| 2.     | WIN-PC04     | john.doe        | 11            |
| 3.     | WIN-SRV02    | svc_admin       | 8             |
| 4.     | WEB-SERVER01 | iis_app         | 7             |
| 5.     | WIN-WS11     | administrator   | 6             |
| 6.     | WIN-PC08     | guest           | 5             |
| 7.     | WIN-DC01     | backup_user     | 4             |
| 8.     | WIN-PC07     | mike.smith      | 3             |
| 9.     | LINUX-SRV01  | root            | 2             |
| 10.    | WIN-DEV01    | dev_user        | 2             |

← These are hosts and users where suspicious commands were found most frequently. Investigate the top results for deeper analysis.





# QUERY 08: Hunt Multiple Security Events (4624, 4625, 4672)



## SPL QUERY:

```
index = windows EventCode IN (4624,4625,4672)
| stats count by EventCode, user
| sort - count
```

## EXAMPLE:

Investigate successful logons (4624), failed logons (4625), and special privilege assignments (4672) to spot suspicious patterns.

## WHAT IT DOES:

Searches for multiple important Windows Security Event IDs and groups the results by EventCode and user to analyze activity.

## WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Correlate authentication success and failures
- Monitor privileged account activity
- Detect suspicious privilege assignments
- Identify brute force + privilege escalation attempts

## QUERY BREAKDOWN:

- `index = windows` → Search Windows logs
- `EventCode IN (4624,4625,4672)` → Search for the listed Event IDs
- `stats count by EventCode, user` → Count events by EventCode and user
- `sort - count` → Highest count first



## BEGINNER TIP:

4624 = Success, 4625 = Failure, 4672 = Special Privilege.  
Always correlate these events with user, host, source IP, and time.

## IMPORTANT EVENT IDs:

- ✓ 4624 → Successful Logon
- ✓ 4625 → Failed Logon
- ✓ 4672 → Special Privileges Assigned

## REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

splunk>enterprise App: Search & Reporting Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

New Search Save As Create Table View Close

index = windows EventCode IN (4624,4625,4672) | stats count by EventCode, user | sort - count Last 24 hours

✓ 35,214 events (5/14/24 12:00:00.000 AM to 5/15/24 12:00:00.000 AM) Job II □ ⬇️ ⬆️ ⋮ 🔍 Smart Mode

Events Patterns Statistics (9) Visualization

|    | EventCode | user          | count |
|----|-----------|---------------|-------|
| 1. | 4624      | administrator | 1,245 |
| 2. | 4625      | administrator | 876   |
| 3. | 4624      | john.doe      | 642   |
| 4. | 4625      | john.doe      | 531   |
| 5. | 4624      | svc_backup    | 408   |
| 6. | 4672      | administrator | 154   |
| 7. | 4625      | svc_admin     | 128   |
| 8. | 4624      | guest         | 89    |
| 9. | 4672      | svc_backup    | 81    |

This shows the top authentication and privilege events across users. Great for spotting brute force and privilege abuse.





# QUERY 09: Build an Investigation Timeline (Sort Events Chronologically)

## SPL QUERY:

```
index = windows user="administrator"
| sort _time
| table _time host src_ip EventCode action
```

## EXAMPLE:

Create a timeline of events for the administrator account to understand what happened, when it happened, and how it unfolded.

## WHAT IT DOES:

Displays events for a specific user in chronological order to help build an investigation timeline.

## WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Understand the full sequence of an attack
- See what happened before and after an alert
- Identify lateral movement or persistence
- Reconstruct attacker behavior step-by-step

## QUERY BREAKDOWN:

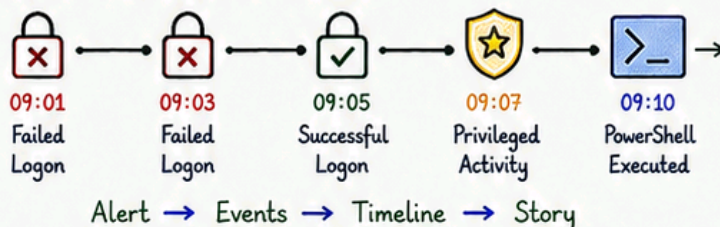
- `index = windows` → Search Windows logs
- `user="administrator"` → Filter for one user
- `sort _time` → Sort events by time
- `table _time host src_ip EventCode action` → Show important columns only



## BEGINNER TIP:

A timeline helps you see the story behind the alert.  
Always look at what happened before and after!

## SAMPLE INVESTIGATION TIMELINE:



## REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

splunk>enterprise App: Search & Reporting Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

New Search Save As Create Table View Close

index = windows user="administrator" | sort \_time | table \_time host src\_ip EventCode action Last 24 hours

✓ 18,452 events (5/14/24 12:00:00.000 AM to 5/15/24 12:00:00.000 AM) Job II □ ↓ 🖨️ ⋮ 🔍 Smart Mode

Events Patterns Statistics (18,452) Visualization

|    | _time               | host     | src_ip      | EventCode | action                      |
|----|---------------------|----------|-------------|-----------|-----------------------------|
| 1. | 5/14/24 09:01:12 AM | WIN-DC01 | 10.10.10.25 | 4625      | Logon Failure               |
| 2. | 5/14/24 09:03:16 AM | WIN-DC01 | 10.10.10.25 | 4625      | Logon Failure               |
| 3. | 5/14/24 09:05:22 AM | WIN-DC01 | 10.10.10.25 | 4624      | Logon Success               |
| 4. | 5/14/24 09:07:45 AM | WIN-DC01 | 10.10.10.25 | 4672      | Special Privileges Assigned |
| 5. | 5/14/24 09:08:10 AM | WIN-DC01 | 10.10.10.25 | 4688      | New Process Created         |
| 6. | 5/14/24 09:09:33 AM | WIN-DC01 | 10.10.10.25 | 4688      | New Process Created         |
| 7. | 5/14/24 09:10:02 AM | WIN-DC01 | 10.10.10.25 | 4688      | PowerShell Executed         |
| 8. | 5/14/24 09:11:18 AM | WIN-DC01 | 10.10.10.25 | 4634      | Logged Off                  |

Chronological view helps you understand the full sequence of events during an incident.





## QUERY 10: Detect Repeated Failed Logins (Possible Brute Force)



### SPL QUERY:

```
index = windows EventCode=4625
| stats count by user, src_ip
| where count > 10
| sort - count
```

### EXAMPLE:

Find users and IPs with more than 10 failed login attempts.  
This helps detect brute force attack attempts.

### WHAT IT DOES:

Finds users and source IPs that have failed to login more than 10 times.

### WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Detect brute force login attempts
- Identify targeted accounts
- Spot attack patterns from specific IPs
- Trigger alerts or block malicious IPs

### QUERY BREAKDOWN:

- `index = windows EventCode=4625` → Find failed logons
- `stats count by user, src_ip` → Count failures by user and IP
- `where count > 10` → Show only suspicious repeated failures
- `sort - count` → Highest failures first



### BEGINNER TIP:

"count > 10" is just an example threshold.  
Adjust based on your organization's baseline and environment.

### -SOC ANALYST WORKFLOW:

- ① Many Failed Logins Detected
- ② Identify User & Source IP
- ③ Check for Successful Login
- ④ Verify IP Reputation
- ⑤ Investigate Further / Block if Needed

### REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

splunk>enterprise App: Search & Reporting Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

New Search Save As Create Table View Close

index = windows EventCode=4625 | stats count by user, src\_ip | where count > 10 | sort - count Last 24 hours

✓ 12,842 events (5/14/24 12:00:00.000 AM to 5/15/24 12:00:00.000 AM) Job II □ ⬇ ⬆ ⋮ 🔍 Smart Mode

| Events | Patterns      | Statistics (42) | Visualization |
|--------|---------------|-----------------|---------------|
|        | user          | src_ip          | count         |
| 1.     | administrator | 10.10.10.25     | 87            |
| 2.     | john.doe      | 10.10.10.30     | 42            |
| 3.     | svc_backup    | 192.168.1.50    | 21            |
| 4.     | admin.user    | 10.10.10.40     | 18            |
| 5.     | test.user     | 172.16.5.20     | 15            |
| 6.     | helpdesk      | 10.10.10.55     | 12            |
| 7.     | guest         | 10.10.10.60     | 11            |

These users from these IPs have failed to login more than 10 times.  
Investigate immediately.





# QUERY 11: Find Rare / Unusual Events (Threat Hunting)



## SPL QUERY:

```
index = windows
| rare EventCode limit=10
```

## EXAMPLE:

Identify EventCodes that appear rarely in your environment. These rare events could indicate misconfigurations, attack attempts, or unusual activity.

## WHAT IT DOES:

Finds event types that occur rarely compared to others in the selected time range.

## WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Threat hunting & anomaly detection
- Discover unknown or overlooked activity
- Detect misconfigurations or rare actions
- Find potential indicators of compromise

## QUERY BREAKDOWN:

- `index = windows` → Search Windows logs
- `rare EventCode` → Show least frequent EventCodes
- `limit=10` → Show top 10 rare results



## BEGINNER TIP:

Rare does not always mean malicious.

Rare = "Worth Investigating".

Always validate the context, user, host, and timeline.

## RARE ≠ MALICIOUS

- ✓ Rare = Unusual
- ✓ Unusual = Investigate
- ✓ Investigate = Understand
- ✓ Understand = Decide

## REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

splunk>enterprise App: Search & Reporting Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

New Search Save As Create Table View Close

index = windows | rare EventCode limit=10 Last 24 hours

✓ 35,987 events (5/14/24 12:00:00.000 AM to 5/15/24 12:00:00.000 AM) Job II □ ⬇️ ⬆️ ⋮ 🔍 Smart Mode

| Events | Patterns    | Statistics (10) | Visualization |
|--------|-------------|-----------------|---------------|
|        | EventCode ▾ | count ▾         |               |
| 1.     | 1102        | 2               |               |
| 2.     | 4697        | 3               |               |
| 3.     | 7045        | 4               |               |
| 4.     | 4672        | 7               |               |
| 5.     | 4769        | 8               |               |
| 6.     | 4738        | 9               |               |
| 7.     | 4663        | 9               |               |
| 8.     | 5038        | 10              |               |
| 9.     | 4719        | 11              |               |
| 10.    | 1074        | 12              |               |

← These are the rarest EventCodes in the selected time range. Investigate these to find hidden signals!





# QUERY 12: Build an Investigation Summary (The Power of stats!)



## SPL QUERY:

```
index = windows
| stats count
  dc(user) as unique_users
  dc(src_ip) as unique_ips
  values(EventCode) as event_codes
  by host
| sort - count
```

## EXAMPLE:

Create a high-level summary of activity across hosts to quickly understand the scope of an incident.

This helps SOC analysts prioritize investigations and spot the most impacted systems.

## WHAT IT DOES:

Provides an overall summary of events, users, IPs, and Event Codes per host.

## WHY SOC ANALYSTS USE IT:

- Get a high-level overview of the environment
- Identify heavily impacted hosts
- Quickly understand users, IPs and event types
- Great starting point for deep-dive investigations

## QUERY BREAKDOWN:

- `index = windows` → Search Windows logs
- `stats count` → Total number of events
- `dc(user) as unique_users` → Count of unique users
- `dc(src_ip) as unique_ips` → Count of unique source IPs
- `values(EventCode) as event_codes` → List of Event Codes observed
- `by host` → Group everything by host
- `sort - count` → Highest events first



## BEGINNER TIP:

Master the `stats` command.

It is the most powerful command for summarizing and understanding data in Splunk.

## KEY TAKEAWAY:

`stats` is the heart of every investigation.

The better you summarize, the faster you respond!



## REAL SPLUNK EXAMPLE:

splunk>enterprise App: Search & Reporting Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

New Search Save As Create Table View Close

index = windows | stats count dc(user) as unique\_users dc(src\_ip) as unique\_ips values(EventCode) as event\_codes by host | sort - count Last 24 hours

✓ 62,418 events (5/14/24 12:00:00.000 AM to 5/15/24 12:00:00.000 AM) Job II □ ⬇️ ⚙️ ⋮ 🔍 Smart Mode

|    | host     | count  | unique_users | unique_ips | event_codes                        |
|----|----------|--------|--------------|------------|------------------------------------|
| 1. | DC01     | 18,542 | 112          | 215        | 4624,4625,4672,4688,1102,7045,4697 |
| 2. | WEB01    | 12,345 | 87           | 163        | 4624,4625,4688,7045,4719,1102      |
| 3. | SRV01    | 8,765  | 54           | 108        | 4624,4672,4697,7045,1102           |
| 4. | FILE01   | 6,224  | 41           | 92         | 4624,4648,4672,4698,1102           |
| 5. | APP01    | 4,321  | 33           | 67         | 4624,4688,4672,7045,1102           |
| 6. | PC01     | 2,879  | 19           | 45         | 4624,4625,4688,1102,4697           |
| 7. | VPCLAB01 | 1,332  | 11           | 28         | 4624,1102,7045                     |

High-level summary across all hosts. Focus on the top hosts and start your investigation there!





## TOP 10 INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

### On SPL & Splunk for SOC Analysts



1

**What is SPL?**

Search Processing Language (SPL) is the query language used in Splunk to search, analyze and visualize machine data.

2

**What are the main parts of an SPL query?**

The main parts are: Search, Pipelines (`|`), Commands, and Fields.

3

**What is the difference between search and stats?**

`Search` retrieves events, while `stats` aggregates and summarizes the data.

4

**How do you find failed login attempts in Splunk?**

Use: `index=windows EventCode=4625`

5

**What does the "stats" command do?**

It aggregates data and calculates statistics like count, sum, avg, dc(), values() etc.

6

**How do you sort results in SPL?**

Use the `sort` command. Example: `| sort - count` (descending order)

7

**What is the difference between count and dc()?**

`count` gives the total number of events.

`dc()` gives the number of distinct (unique) values.

8

**How do you filter results in SPL?**

Use the `where` command to filter based on conditions.

Example: `| where count > 10`

9

**What is the use of rare command?**

The `rare` command helps to find uncommon or unusual events in your dataset.

10

**How do you display specific fields in SPL results?**

Use the `table` command to display only required fields.

Example: `| table _time user host src_ip EventCode`

### KEY POINTS TO REMEMBER

- SPL is all about searching and understanding data.
- Use `stats` to summarize, `sort` to prioritize, and `where` to filter.
- Always focus on the **who, what, when, where** and **how**.
- Practice with real logs and build your own queries.
- The more you practice, the better you investigate!



### INTERVIEW TIP

When answering SPL questions:

- ✓ Explain the purpose
- ✓ Mention the commands
- ✓ Provide a simple example
- ✓ Show how it helps in SOC investigations

Clarity > Complexity



### Remember:

SPL is a skill that improves with practice.  
Keep exploring. Keep learning. Keep defending!

